



The Home–School Connection

A structured bridge so home and school speak the same language and pull in the same direction.

When a child hears "flip the critic" in class on Tuesday and "talk to yourself like a friend" at home on Wednesday, the skill becomes a culture. This system gives students, parents, educators, counselors, and caregivers a **shared vocabulary**, a simple **reflection loop** between classroom and kitchen table, and a light way to **track growth** over a year — without adding homework or paperwork to anyone's night.

THE HOME–SCHOOL REFLECTION LOOP

One round-trip per pillar. It takes a teacher two minutes to send and a family ten minutes to complete. The point isn't compliance — it's a shared moment.

STEP 1 · SCHOOL

Send

Teacher sends home a one-line prompt tied to the week's pillar and lesson.

STEP 2 · HOME

Reflect

Family talks it over for 10 minutes and jots one sentence together.

STEP 3 · HOME

Return

The single sentence comes back — on paper, photo, or a quick note.

STEP 4 · SCHOOL

Close

Teacher reads a few aloud (anonymously) to open the next lesson.

The loop turns "what did you do at school today?" — "nothing" — into a conversation the whole family already has the words for.

FAMILY FOLLOW-UPS TIED TO ASSESSMENT RESULTS

When a student's check-in or assessment highlights a pillar, send home the matching follow-up. Each is strengths-based — never a deficit note.

IF IDENTITY IS THE GROWTH AREA

Send the "**Catch them being**" practice and the strengths-jar activity. Ask the family to notice and name character (not grades) once a day for a week.

IF SELF-COMPASSION IS THE GROWTH AREA

Send the "**Flip the critic**" / **friend test**. Encourage a nightly one-line kind thing each person says to themselves.

IF FORGIVENESS IS THE GROWTH AREA

Send the **four-step redo** card and "mistake of the week." Invite one real repair before the next check-in.

IF GRACE IS THE GROWTH AREA

Send "**connection before correction**" and the benefit-of-the-doubt activity. Ask the family to track one grace moment a day.

THE SHARED GRACE VOCABULARY

The heart of the bridge: a handful of phrases everyone — students, parents, teachers, counselors, caregivers — uses the same way. Post it in the classroom and on the fridge. When the words match, the work compounds.

PHRASE	PILLAR	WHAT IT MEANS	SOUNDS LIKE
Catch them being	● Identity	Noticing character out loud, not just achievement.	"I noticed how patient you were."
Praise the person	● Identity	Affirming who someone is becoming, beyond the grade.	"You're becoming someone who keeps trying."
Flip the critic	● Self-Comp.	Turning harsh self-talk into kinder, truer words.	"That's the critic. What's the kinder truth?"
Talk to yourself like a friend	● Self-Comp.	Offering yourself the grace you'd give a friend.	"What would you tell a friend right now?"
The redo	● Forgiveness	The four-step repair: own it · name the impact · make it right · reset.	"Want a redo? Let's walk the four steps."
Set it down	● Forgiveness	Choosing to release a grudge that's costing too much.	"Is this one worth carrying?"
Connection before correction	● Grace	One calm breath and one kind question before the lecture.	"Looks like a rough one — tell me what happened."
Benefit of the doubt	● Grace	Assuming a kind reason before a harsh one.	"What's a story we don't know yet?"
Your calm is the intervention	● Grace	The adult's regulation is the first tool, every time.	(A breath, then a softer voice.)

CONVERSATION GUIDES TIED TO LESSON TOPICS

AFTER AN IDENTITY LESSON At home: "Today you talked about who you are. What's one strength your teacher would say you have? Do you agree?" Bridge line: "We catch each other being good here too."	AFTER A SELF-COMPASSION LESSON At home: "You practiced talking to yourself like a friend. When did you need that today?" Bridge line: "Let's flip the critic together at dinner."
AFTER A FORGIVENESS LESSON At home: "You learned the four repair steps. Want to teach them to me?" Bridge line: "Any redos owed around here this week?"	AFTER A GRACE LESSON At home: "You talked about grace today. Who gave you some? Who did you give it to?" Bridge line: "Connection before correction — call me out when I forget."

FAMILY GROWTH TRACKING

A light, encouraging way to see movement across a term. No scores, no ranking — just "where are we noticing growth, and what's our next small step?" Revisit it monthly.

THE FOUR-PILLAR PULSE (MONTHLY)

- For each pillar, the family marks: **Just starting** • **Growing** • **Strong**.
- Pick the **one** pillar to focus on next month.
- Name a single practice from the Grace at Home pages to try.
- Keep last month's sheet — progress is the point, not the grade.

WHAT SCHOOLS CAN MIRROR

- Teachers track the same four pillars as **class goals**, not student scores.
- Counselors use the pulse language in check-ins for continuity.
- Home + school name the **same focus pillar** each month when possible.
- Celebrate movement together — a shared win, not a report card.

PARENT RESOURCES CONNECTED TO CLASSROOM LEARNING

A TWO-LINE WEEKLY NOTE HOME

Teachers send: "This week we're practicing **[pillar]**. At home, try **[one practice]** and ask **[one question]**." That's the whole resource — small enough to actually use.

THE PILLAR MINI-EXPLAINERS

One short paragraph per pillar in plain language, so a parent who never saw the lesson can still speak the same words. Pair with the vocabulary card.

"TRY THIS AT HOME" CARDS

The four-pillar fridge card (Identity / Self-Compassion / Forgiveness / Grace) gives families a no-prep ritual for each pillar — the at-home twin of the classroom lesson.

FOR CAREGIVERS & COUNSELORS

The same vocabulary and loop work for grandparents, sitters, and counselors — anyone in a child's circle can reinforce one consistent language.

A TERM IN FOUR MOVES

Month 1 introduce the vocabulary at home and school. **Month 2** run the reflection loop once per pillar. **Month 3** add the monthly pulse and pick a shared focus pillar. **Month 4** celebrate growth and start a family reflection journal (next page).

Family Reflection Journal (optional)

One page a week. Fill a few lines together — a keepsake of how your family grew in grace.

THIS WEEK'S PILLAR · ☐ IDENTITY ☐ SELF-COMPASSION ☐ FORGIVENESS ☐ GRACE

A MOMENT WE PRACTICED IT

When did our pillar show up this week?

SOMETHING A CHILD SAID

A line worth remembering.

SOMETHING A GROWN-UP LEARNED

Where did we grow?

A REPAIR WE MADE

Any redo, big or small?

GRACE WE GAVE OR RECEIVED

Who was gentle with whom?

NEXT SMALL STEP

One thing to try next week.

HOW TO USE THE JOURNAL

- Keep it where the family gathers; fill it Sunday or any quiet moment.
- Let different people write each week — including the kids.
- Read last month's page now and then. Growth is easier to see backward.
- Twelve pages becomes a year-long **Family Grace Journey** keepsake.

THE WHOLE BRIDGE, IN ONE HABIT

The journal closes the loop: school plants the pillar, home practices it, the journal remembers it, and the next conversation starts from somewhere real. That's the home-school connection working — not as paperwork, but as a shared story your family is writing together.